

Joshua Lieberstein

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jmlieberstein.github.io

Education

University of California, Santa Cruz (2021–Present)
MA, Linguistics, Expected June 2027
BA, Linguistics *cum laude*, June 2025

Non-Degree Education

Mayan Language Institute, *Advanced K'iche'*, Organized by Tulane University, Summer 2025

Awards & Honors

2026	Graduate Research Fellowship (National Science Foundation)
2026	Fulbright Foundation (Semi-Finalist)
2025	Foreign Language Area Studies Fellowship (Summer), Vanderbilt University (\$8500)
2025	The Humanities Institute Fellowship, UC Santa Cruz (\$1000)
2022-2024	Dean's Honors, UC Santa Cruz

Publications

1. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Ambiguity Advantage Effect in Wh-Questions*, Accepted in UGA Working Papers.

Presentations

Talks at conferences

- T1. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Reportatives and Quotatives in K'iche' (Mayan)*, Workshop on American Indigenous Languages (WAIL28)... Upcoming. May 2026.
- T2. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Cláusulas sin verbo en el k'iche' chichicasteco: un enfoque (no) copulativo* ["Verbless Clauses in Chichicastenango K'iche': A (Non)-Copular Focus"], Guatemalan Scholars Network (GSN). July 2025.

Invited talks

- T3. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Polarity, Ellipsis and Verb-Initial Order in K'iche' (Mayan)*, Linguistics at Santa Cruz 40 (LASC40), UC Santa Cruz. Apr. 2026.
- T4. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Reportatives and Quotatives in K'iche' (Mayan)*, American Indian Seminar (AIS), UCLA. Apr. 2026.
- T5. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Polarity, Ellipsis and Verb-Initial Order in K'iche' (Mayan)*, American Indian Seminar (AIS), UCLA. Sept. 2025.

- T6. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Specific Subjects and the Ergative Extraction Constraint in K'iche'*, American Indian Seminar (AIS), UCLA. Sept. 2025.

Other talks

- T7. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Polarity, Ellipsis and Verb-Initial Order in K'iche' (Mayan)*, Syntax and Semantics Circle (S-Circle), UC Santa Cruz. Oct. 2025.
- T8. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Verbless Clauses in Mayan K'iche': A Copular Investigation*, Syntax and Semantics Circle (S-Circle), UC Santa Cruz. Feb. 2025.
- T9. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Ambiguity Advantage Effect in Wh-Questions*, Speech and Sentence Processing Lab (s/lab), UC Santa Cruz. Nov. 2024.

Posters

- P1. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Verbless Clauses in K'iche' (Mayan): A (Non)-Copular Investigation*, Linguistics Undergraduate Research Colloquium, UC Santa Cruz. May 2025.
- P2. **Lieberstein, Joshua & Wagers, M.** *Ambiguity Advantage in Wh-Questions*, Human Sentence Processing (HSP38), University of Maryland. Mar. 2025.
- P3. Green, S., Karasso, S. & **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Ambiguity Advantage in Wh-Questions*, Linguistics Undergraduate Research Colloquium, UC Santa Cruz. June 2023.

Research Experience

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| 2024-Present | Fieldwork, Chichicastenango K'iche' (Eastern Mayan) |
| 2022-2024 | Research Assistant, IntERPrET Lab , UC Santa Cruz, (Advisor: Dr. Liv Hoversten) |
| 2022-2023 | Research Assistant, Sentence Processing Lab, UC Santa Cruz, (Advisor: Dr. Stephanie Rich) |

Teaching @ UC Santa Cruz

Teaching Assistant

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| Spring 2026 | LING171: Psycholinguistics 1
Instructor: <i>Amanda Rysling</i> |
| Winter 2026 | LING53: Semantics 1
Instructor: <i>Pranav Anand</i> |
| Fall 2025 | LING50: Intro to Linguistics
Instructor: <i>Matt Wagers</i> |

Tutor

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| | LING112: Syntax 1 |
| Fall 2024 | Instructor: <i>Roumyana Pancheva</i> |
| Winter 2024 | Instructor: <i>Maziar Toosarvandani</i> |
| Winter 2023 | Instructor: <i>Ivy Sichel</i> |

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| Fall 2022 | Independent Writing Tutor |
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Academic Service

- 2024-Present Linguistics Events Planning Committee, *UC Santa Cruz*
 Chair, Transportation Subcommittee
 Member, Transportation Subcommittee
- 2024 **Volunteer/Student**, [INEPAS](#), Quetzaltenango, Guatemala. Spanish Language
 School/Social Work

Skills

Languages Spoken: English (native); Spanish (advanced); K'iche' (research)

Technical Skills: $\text{\LaTeX}$, R, Python, PCibex

Last updated: April 21, 2026